For Bhagwant Das it would have been a moment of great pride and accomplishment to have the birth of his granddaughter celebrated with all the extravagance due a Mughal shahzaadi that she was. The following year, in August 1587, Bhagwant Das's daughter gave birth to a son whom Akbar named Sultan Khusrau. Another Rajput rajkumari entered Salim's household in June 1586, when one of Akbar's favourite courtiers, Raja Rai Singh of Bikaner, married his daughter to the prince. Akbar was very fond of the Raja of Bikaner, who was not only an indefatigable warrior but also demonstrated all the ideal traits of a great Mughal courtier. He was a generous patron to writers and poets and was himself a scholar of Sanskrit, writing the *Rai Singh Mahotsav*, on the treatment of diseases, in Sanskrit. He was a magnanimous and careful ruler, protecting not only those of his own faith but those of other faiths as well, including the Jains. Like the other influential courtiers surrounding the Padshah, the raja was a patron of architecture and built the Junagarh Fort outside Bikaner, in an indigenous style with traces of Mughal influence. When in 1592 one of Raja Rai Singh's daughters was widowed, Akbar rode to comfort the raja and his daughter, and to plead with the widow not to commit sati, for the sake of her children. For the Padshah of Hindustan to condole with a courtier in his own home was a very special honour and a testament to the great affection Akbar had for the family of Bikaner.

The Marwar Rathores sent a daughter in 1586, Rajkumari Mani Bai (also known as Jagat Gosain), the daughter of Rao Udai Singh, to be married to Prince Salim. It was noted that Akbar and the ladies of the harem went to Udai Singh's house for the celebration of the marriage. Upon her marriage to Salim, Akbar gave her the title Taj Bibi though she was popularly known as Jodh Bai, for her home state of Jodhpur. Udai Singh was given the title raja, and awarded a mansab of 1,000.

Munis Faruqui has pointed out that from this time onwards, Akbar recused* himself from further marriage alliances and instead encouraged his three sons to contract a large number of marriages between them. For royal marriages were not only a way to ensure heirs but, much more potently, as demonstrated by Ruby Lal, a way to incorporate a diverse peoples into the protective embrace of the Mughal Empire. From this time onwards no non-royal pretender to the Mughal throne would be tolerated but for Akbar's sons, gilded with wealth, courtiers and powerful in-laws, the empire was theirs to claim.